Standardness of the double branched cover of $\tau^0\rho^1\,P(-2,3,7)$ and of a related homotopy four-sphere

~~A computer-assisted proof~~ Computer-assisted proofs with explicit move certificates

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Working draft – ~~28 October~~ 5 November 2026 – Revision ~~6~~6.1

Abstract

Let $J = P(-2,3,7)$ and let X_0 be the double cover of S^4 branched over the zero-twist, one-roll spin of J. We give a computer-assisted proof that X_0 is PL-homeomorphic, and hence diffeomorphic, to the standard four-sphere. The proof combines a geometric construction and reduction certificate identifying X_0 with a six-pentachoron triangulation G_6, and a new explicit certificate connecting G_6 to the double of a four-simplex. The latter consists of three paths with 8,436 local moves in total: 7,842 Pachner moves and 594 admissible edge or triangle 2–0 moves. All 8,436 terminal moves have been independently replayed. A second implementation checks the admissibility and resulting facet pairings of all 594 2–0 steps without invoking Regina's 2–0 move routines. We state the geometric input, explain the cap replacement, and describe the verification dependencies. The resulting diffeomorphism answers Question 1.4 of Hughes, Kim and Miller in the affirmative. Combined with their periodicity theorem and results of Teragaito, it shows that $\Sigma_2(S^4, \tau^m\rho^1(J))$ is diffeomorphic to S^4 whenever $m \equiv 0, 2, 3 \pmod 4$.

We also treat a second homotopy four-sphere Z, presented by a handle diagram of the third author. The diagram is obtained by modifying his handle diagram of X_0, and Z is not known to be a double branched cover of a two-knot. His first drawing of the diagram differs from the final one in two crossings, and the two are related by a single handle slide. We put the first drawing into the standard position required by Burke's converter Katie and certify that its framed link is unchanged. Katie gives a triangulation of the 0-, 1- and 2-handles. We close it with an explicit triangulation of $\natural_2(S^1 \times B^3)$ and reduce the resulting 24,170-pentachoron triangulation to the double of a four-simplex by 781,277 recorded moves. All of these moves have been replayed. With the handle slide, this shows that Z is diffeomorphic to S^4. A separate direct computation from a redrawing of the final diagram reduces Z to a specified six-pentachoron triangulation Z_6; the proof above does not rely on a separate standardness identification of that endpoint.

1. The result and the certificate structure

For a classical knot J, write $\tau^m\rho^n(J)$ for its twist-roll spin, with m the twist parameter and n the roll parameter. For a smoothly embedded surface F in S^4, write $\Sigma_2(S^4, F)$ for the double branched cover. We use the conventions of Hughes, Kim and Miller [1] and set

$$J = P(-2,3,7), \qquad X_0 = \Sigma_2\Big(S^4, \tau^0\rho^1(J)\Big).$$

Miyazawa [2] used the two-knot $\tau^0\rho^1(J)$ to construct infinitely many exotic projective-plane knots. Hughes, Kim and Miller proved that $\Sigma_2(S^4, \tau^m\rho^n(K))$ is unchanged up to diffeomorphism when m

is replaced by $m+4$ [1, Theorem 1.1]. They deduced that the homotopy $\overline{\mathbb{CP}}^2$s arising as double branched covers of Miyazawa's projective-plane knots are standard [1, Corollary 1.2], and asked whether X_0 is diffeomorphic to S^4 [1, Question 1.4].

Teragaito's unknotted examples $\tau^{18}\rho^1(J)$ and $\tau^{19}\rho^1(J)$ [3], together with that periodicity, already settle the twists $m \equiv 2, 3 \pmod 4$; see [1, proof of Corollary 1.2 and Remark 1.3(1)]. Kuhrman [4, Corollary 2.9] identifies X_0 as the result of a Gluck twist on S^4.

The branched-cover formula gives $\chi(X_0) = 2\chi(S^4) - \chi(S^2) = 2$. Together with the verified trivial fundamental group (Section 2.4), Poincaré duality implies that X_0 is a homotopy four-sphere. Freedman's theorem [5] therefore gives a homeomorphism $X_0 \cong S^4$. Question 1.4 concerns its smooth structure. A triangulation answers that question when its PL structure is compatible with the given smooth structure of X_0; Section 2 establishes this compatibility for the construction used here.

The proof uses a specified marked triangulation of the branched cover and finite certificates of PL equivalence. The markings identify the geometric construction; the subsequent standardization concerns the underlying manifold. For this zero-twist standardness assertion, reversing the roll direction or the orientation used to parameterize J does not affect the conclusion (Remark 2.4).

Theorem 1.1. The manifold $X_0 = \Sigma_2(S^4, \tau^0\rho^1\, P(-2,3,7))$, identified by the construction certificate described in Section 2, is PL-homeomorphic to the standard S^4. Its compatible smooth structure is therefore diffeomorphic to the standard smooth four-sphere.

The proof has two logically separate parts. The construction and reduction certificates identify X_0 with the explicit six-pentachoron triangulation G_6 in Table 1. A terminal certificate then connects G_6 to the double of a four-simplex by admissible PL-preserving local moves. The latter certificate also proves the following standalone theorem.

Theorem 1.2. The closed generalized triangulation G_6 with isomorphism signature
`gAMLMQaabcdeffff2a+a2avbmaoaxaOb0aUa`
is PL-homeomorphic to the standard four-sphere.

Corollary 1.3. For every integer m with $m \equiv 0, 2, 3 \pmod 4$, the manifold $\Sigma_2(S^4, \tau^m\rho^1(J))$ is diffeomorphic to the standard S^4. In particular, the Gluck twist realizing X_0 in [4, Corollary 2.9] has standard total space.

Proof. For $m \equiv 0 \pmod 4$, apply Theorem 1.1 and the periodicity in [1, Theorem 1.1]. For $m \equiv 2, 3 \pmod 4$, apply that periodicity to Teragaito's unknotted 18- and 19-twist examples. The statement about the Gluck twist is Theorem 1.1 applied to Kuhrman's identification.

For the fixed one-roll family, the sole twist residue class not covered by Corollary 1.3 is $m \equiv 1 \pmod 4$. By the four-twist periodicity of [1, Theorem 1.1], all covers in this residue class are diffeomorphic to $\Sigma_2(S^4, \tau^1\rho^1(J))$.

Handle diagrams. The third author has a Kirby diagram of X_0 (Figure 1), with three 1-handles drawn as dotted circles and five 2-handles with framings $0, 0, 0, 0, -1$. Modifying that diagram gives the diagram of Figure 2, which presents a closed four-manifold Z. The geometric meaning of the modification is not yet understood; in particular, Z is not known to be a double branched cover of a two-knot. The third author computed that $\pi_1(Z)$ is trivial. Section 7 shows that Z is a homotopy four-sphere and proves:

Theorem 1.4. The closed four-manifold Z presented by the handle diagram of Figure 2 is diffeomorphic, and hence PL-homeomorphic, to the standard S^4.

The proof is independent of the proof of Theorem 1.1. Figure 1 is not used in the proof of Theorem 1.1; Remark 7.5 discusses its role. The third author's first drawings of Figures 1 and 2 differed from the present figures in two crossings at one spot, and he observed that the two versions are related by a single handle slide (Lemma 7.1). Our certificate is computed from the first drawing of Figure 2, and Lemma 7.1 transfers it to Z. A direct computation from a redrawing of Figure 2 (Proposition 7.4) gives a separate reduction to the specified six-pentachoron triangulation Z_6. Section 7.6 distinguishes that reduction from the complete standardization through Z°.

A pentachoron is a four-simplex. A generalized triangulation is specified by affine identifications between facets of abstract pentachora; different faces or vertices of one pentachoron may have the same image in the quotient. This convention permits the very small triangulations used below. A simplicial complex is used in the initial reduction, before conversion to a generalized triangulation.

The construction dossier and earlier reduction are explicit inputs to this note, summarized in Sections 2–3. The terminal standardness certificate is treated in Sections 4–5. Appendix A identifies the exact files and verification commands. File hashes bind particular computations to their inputs; they do not replace the geometric argument identifying a triangulation with the desired branched cover.

Table 1. Named triangulations and exact classic isomorphism signatures.

Name	Meaning	Pentachora
G_6	Endpoint of the construction reduction	6
W	Common endpoint of two terminal paths	6
S_6	Six-pentachoron standard reference	6
S_2	Double of a four-simplex	2
T_5	Punctured endpoint before recapping	5
Z_8°	Endpoint of the closed reduction of Z° (Section 7.5)	8
W_4	Common endpoint of the two terminal paths for Z°	4
Z_8	Endpoint of the direct reduction of Z (Section 7.6)	8
Z_6	Six-pentachoron triangulation reached from Z_8	6

G_6	`gAMLMQaabcdeffff2a+a2avbmaoaxaOb0aUa`
W	`gLAMPQaccddefefffaaaubaaMafapboapboa`
S_6	`gLAPPQacbedeeffffaaawaaaobcacaQbPboa`
S_2	`cPkbbbbaaaaaaaa`
T_5	`fHMLQcabcdeeeecanbpaoazaobWbGb`
Z_8°	`iLAALMQkabcccfefhghhhcaaavava2aaaoacbZb6aEa8a8a`
W_4	`eLAQcabbcdddcaaaga2amamaya`
Z_8	`iLLLAQQkbcfdegegfghhhUagbdayaSazawaob8aca1atbba`
Z_6	`gALLQQaacdeffeffqbgaJbCa5ajbwbQbwbwb`

2. The geometric construction input

Let K_0 denote the marked master triangulation specified in Supplement C1. It has 103,744 four-simplices and 4,310 vertices. The following statement records the geometric content used from that construction.

Construction input 2.1. The PL four-manifold underlying K_0 admits the smooth manifold $X_0 = \Sigma_2(S^4, \tau^0\rho^1(J))$ as a compatible smoothing. Equivalently, K_0 is PL-homeomorphic to a Whitehead triangulation of X_0.

Lemmas 2.2 and 2.3 reduce this identification to three marked geometric identifications: the source, the relative monodromy, and the cap attachment. Section 2.3 explains how the maps and checks in C1 establish them. Section 2.4 records complementary consistency checks.

2.1. A decomposition of the branched cover

Let (B^3, a) be obtained from (S^3, J) by removing a small open ball centred on a point of J, leaving a knotted arc a. In the roll-spinning construction of Litherland [6], as described in [1, Section 2], the roll monodromy R is a diffeomorphism of (B^3, a) fixing a boundary collar. As a diffeomorphism of the ball alone, it is isotopic to the identity relative to the boundary [10]. Thus its ambient mapping torus is $B^3 \times S^1$, and the zero-twist pair has the decomposition

$$(S^4, \tau^0\rho^1(J)) \cong \big((B^3, a) \times_R S^1\big) \cup_{\mathrm{id}} \big((S^2, \partial a) \times D^2\big).$$

The identity attachment is taken in the fixed boundary product coordinates. The roll is supported in a collar $T^2 \times [0, 1]$ of the torus $T^2 = \partial\nu(\partial B^3 \cup a)$, where ν denotes a regular neighbourhood. Identify this with the peripheral torus of J and fix its preferred zero-linking longitude λ and meridian μ. Our ordered parametrization $\varphi : (\mathbb{R}/\mathbb{Z})^2 \to T^2$ satisfies

$$s \longmapsto \varphi(s, v_0) \text{ represents } \lambda, \qquad s \longmapsto \varphi(u_0, s) \text{ represents } \mu.$$

Thus u records position along a longitude at fixed v, and v records position along a meridian at fixed u. In these coordinates the collar map is

$$R(u, v, r) = (u + h(r), v, r),$$

where h increases from 0 on the tube side to 1 on the exterior side and is constant near the endpoints. This agrees with [1, proof of Proposition 2.1], whose ordered circle coordinates are (μ, λ): our u is their longitude coordinate and our v their meridian coordinate, each normalized to period one. For a transverse arc $\gamma(r) = (u_0, v_0, r)$, the endpoints of $R\gamma$ and γ agree and

$$[R\gamma \cdot \gamma^{-1}] = [\lambda] \quad \text{in } H_1(T^2 \times [0, 1]; \mathbb{Z}).$$

Here the concatenation first follows $R\gamma$, then γ in reverse. Its longitude and meridian windings are $(1, 0)$.

We distinguish the downstairs meridian coordinate v from the upstairs coordinate $\widetilde{v}$ used by the triangulation. The covering map and involution on the peripheral torus are

$$q(u, \widetilde{v}) = (u, 2\widetilde{v}), \qquad \iota(u, \widetilde{v}) = (u, \widetilde{v} + \tfrac{1}{2}).$$

The lift of the roll is therefore $(u, \widetilde{v}, r) \mapsto (u + h(r), \widetilde{v}, r)$. In contrast, the one-meridian shear downstairs lifts to $(u, \widetilde{v}, r) \mapsto (u, \widetilde{v} + h(r)/2, r)$: it extends as the identity on the tube/puncture side and as the deck involution on the exterior side. Its exterior mapping torus has a deck identification at the time seam, as in the odd-twist case of [1, proof of Theorem 1.1]. A full turn in $\widetilde{v}$ would represent two meridional turns downstairs.

Lemma 2.2. Let $V = \Sigma_2(S^3, J)$, let V_* be the complement of an invariant open ball centred on the branch circle, and let R' be the lift of R that is the identity on a boundary collar. In the marked product coordinates on $\partial V_* \times S^1$, there is a diffeomorphism

$$X_0 \cong (V_* \times_{R'} S^1) \cup_{\mathrm{id}} (S^2 \times D^2),$$

and R' is one longitudinal shear on the lifted collar.

Proof. Take double branched covers of the pieces. The cover of (B^3, a) is V_*, and its mapping torus lifts to the mapping torus of R'. The double cover of S^2 branched at the two points of ∂a is again S^2, so the cap lifts to $S^2 \times D^2$. The two lifts of the identity attachment differ by the deck transformation, which extends over the cap. Choosing the identity lift in the marked coordinates gives the displayed union. The longitude has linking number zero with J and therefore lifts homeomorphically; one longitudinal shear remains one upstairs. For this knot, V is the Brieskorn homology sphere $\Sigma(2, 3, 7)$, up to orientation.

2.2. Relative PL models and compatible smoothings

Three-dimensional manifolds have compatible PL and smooth structures, with the usual uniqueness and relative approximation results [8, 9]. In particular, the relative mapping class of a smooth diffeomorphism fixing a boundary collar has a compatible PL representative. An isotopy fixed on that collar induces an equivalence of mapping tori preserving the boundary product coordinates. Gluing compatible models along the corresponding boundary maps then gives the PL structure underlying the glued smooth manifold. The smooth conclusion for that fixed PL four-manifold uses uniqueness of compatible smoothings [7, Theorem 3.5(2)]; see also [9, Part II, Theorem 4.2] and [10].

Lemma 2.3. Suppose P is a PL model of V_* with a specified identification of its boundary collar. Suppose $g : P \to P$ is a PL homeomorphism fixed on that collar whose relative PL mapping class, under this marked identification, is the class of a compatible PL representative of R'. If K_0 is PL-homeomorphic to $(P \times_g S^1) \cup_{\mathrm{id}} (S^2 \times D^2)$, with the standard cap and the identity attachment in those product coordinates, then Construction input 2.1 holds.

Proof. Replace g, by an isotopy fixed on the boundary collar, with the compatible PL model of R'. The induced equivalence of mapping tori preserves the product coordinates on $S^2 \times S^1$ and therefore extends across the identity cap. The resulting PL manifold is a compatible triangulation of the smooth union in Lemma 2.2. That union is X_0, proving the claim.

2.3. What the construction certificate establishes

Source. The source is assembled from equivariant Seifert pieces, initially with 7,440 tetrahedra and then compressed to 628. Its deck involution has quotient S^3. A peripheral-preserving PL identification of its branch exterior with the exterior of the signed 12-crossing diagram $T(-1/2) + T(1/3) + T(1/7)$ is obtained by the recorded source/import transport and an exact combinatorial isomorphism of the resulting marked triangulations. Both the meridian and longitude are preserved. Meridian filling therefore recovers the pair (S^3, J). The source audit also checks the determinant and Alexander polynomial. The recorded native simplification and peripheral transport semantics, including the use of SnapPy and Spherogram, remain dependencies of this identification.

Peripheral coordinates. In the downstairs source quotient, write N for the solid tube and E for the knot exterior. The coordinate periods are restrictions of closed integral cocycles c_N on N and c_E on

E. The first evaluates to $+1$ on the actual core curve; the second evaluates to $+1$ on a geometric normal meridian. A separate replay of the mesh presentations verifies $H_1(N) = H_1(E) = \mathbb{Z}$. The actual peripheral loops have (c_N, c_E)-periods $(1, 0)$ for λ and $(0, 1)$ for μ. Consequently the first direction is the core-positive zero-framing longitude: its exterior homology class is zero. The rational vertex potentials used to flatten the torus telescope to zero on these loops. Exact adaptor checks preserve this ordered basis, and all 516 upstairs peripheral edges satisfy the projection equation $\Delta(u, v) = (\Delta u, 2\Delta\tilde{v})$.

Monodromy. The mapping-torus bulk contains 73,696 pentachora and carries the roll in a central collar. A six-piece affine source-profile transfer, with checked inverses, face matchings and seam equations, identifies the recorded monodromy with the central longitudinal shear. Its winding is one in the longitude and zero in the meridian, both upstairs and downstairs, and it is the identity near the puncture. The comparison is relative to the marked ports and boundary collar. An additional audit reconstructs all 11,136 central pentachora in the accepted master and both source interfaces. It checks the rational chart identifications and traces a transverse arc and its image through 6 and 14 actual master pentachora, respectively. Their endpoints agree as barycentric combinations of the same global vertices, and their closed difference has longitude and meridian periods $(1, 0)$. The scripts and full rational path records are provided in the repository's `coordinate_audit/` supplement. These checks make the direction of the implemented shear explicit; the previously stated source-transport dependencies remain.

Cap. Product collars containing 24,224 pentachora join the 96-tetrahedron boundary of the mapping-torus piece to the $1,792$-tetrahedron cap boundary. The cap contains 5,824 pentachora: two four-balls, each a $2,912$-pentachoron cone on the boundary of $D^2 \times D^2$, glued along the filling solid torus to form $S^2 \times D^2$. For $m = 0$, the attaching map is the identity on all 1,792 boundary tetrahedra in the marked coordinates, checked at exact rational coordinates.

Assembly. An independent checker regenerates all 103,744 pentachora from these pieces and checks the gluings, orientation and full fixed subcomplex of the involution. The latter is a two-sphere with face vector $(106, 312, 208)$. Equivariant local branch models are checked at every stratum. Once the marked source, monodromy and cap identifications are established, Lemma 2.3 concerns the underlying PL manifold; the branch checks additionally verify the intended marked covering structure.

The manifold premise for the cover has an independent finite certificate. Each of the 4,310 vertex links reduces by checked three-dimensional bistellar moves to the boundary of a four-simplex. The collection contains 529,460 such moves. Thus the marked master is a closed combinatorial four-manifold. This link verification is separate from, and supplements, the geometric identification in Construction input 2.1.

2.4. Consistency checks on the construction

The marked identifications above determine the constructed manifold. The following checks test complementary features of the implementation.

The roll. With no roll, the same product-cap construction would give the spin of V, with fundamental group $\pi_1(V) \neq 1$. By contrast, the full two-skeleton of K_0 gives a presentation reduced to the trivial group by recorded Tietze moves, including 60,487 generator eliminations. This rules out that no-roll alternative. The relative monodromy certificate itself establishes the required longitudinal winding one.

The cap. In the construction's angle and time units, the unwrapped displacement of the $m = 0$ attachment is $(0, 4)$, compared with $(-8, 4)$ for the $m = 2$ control. The $m = 0$ attachment is the identity in the marked boundary coordinates. The two caps differ in 3,008 of their 5,824 pentachora. The exact attaching-map checks identify the filling class; the facet counts are consistency checks.

The source and control. The peripheral-preserving source identification fixes the knot pair (S^3, J). The $m = 0$ and $m = 2$ constructions share the source, exterior, roll and boundary adaptor. Their masters have 100,736 common facets, and their vertex labels, deck map, and marked branch and twin spheres agree. The separate reduction and terminal certificate below establish standardness of X_0.

The swapped-coordinate control. We also implement the downstairs meridional shear

$$R_{\mathrm{tw}}(u, v, r) = (u, v + h(r), r),$$

using the half-turn lift and exterior deck seam described in Section 2.1. Its transverse-arc comparison has peripheral winding $(0, 1)$. The resulting closed master has 101,056 pentachora and 4,226 vertices. All 4,226 vertex links are recognized as PL three-spheres by Regina 7.4.1. A separate simplicial move certificate reduces this master to $\partial\Delta^5$, the boundary of a five-simplex: it contains 4,203 edge contractions satisfying the full link condition, 134,673 moves of type 3–3, 18,138 of type 4–2, 4,297 of type 2–4 and 17 of type 5–1, for 161,328 moves in total. An independent checker replays every move from the original master. The reduction and its replay use standard Python; Regina is used for vertex-link recognition, with no Regina four-dimensional simplification in this reduction. Supplement C6 supplies the input, move log and strict verification launcher (Appendix A).

This is a successful control of the swapped-coordinate construction. Since both covers are standard, their standardness alone does not distinguish the longitudinal and meridional shears. That distinction is supplied by the marked peripheral basis and the transverse-arc windings in Sections 2.1 and 2.3.

Remark 2.4. For $m = 0$, reversing the roll replaces R by R^{-1}. Reversal of the mapping-torus circle, extended over the cap by complex conjugation on D^2, gives an orientation-reversing diffeomorphism between the resulting covers. Reversing the orientation used to parameterize J reverses the longitudinal direction and is covered by the same argument. Since the standard four-sphere admits an orientation-reversing self-diffeomorphism, these choices do not change the zero-twist standardness conclusion. Corollary 1.3 uses the fixed twist and roll conventions of [1].

3. Reduction to six pentachora

Proposition 3.1. The underlying unmarked PL manifold of K_0 is PL-homeomorphic to G_6.

3.1. Simplicial contractions and bistellar moves

The first trace contracts 3,308 edges and reduces the master to a simplicial complex with 44,620 facets and 1,002 vertices. Every contraction satisfies the full link condition

$$\mathrm{lk}_K(u) \cap \mathrm{lk}_K(v) = \mathrm{lk}_K(uv).$$

For a triangulation of a compact PL manifold without boundary, this condition guarantees that the edge contraction preserves PL type; see Nevo [11, Theorem 1.4]. The checks use the full face sets, rather than only the vertex sets of the links.

A second simplicial trace consists of 629,874 checked moves: 957 full-link edge contractions, 50,016 bistellar 2–4 moves, 517,325 bistellar 3–3 moves, and 61,576 bistellar 4–2 moves. Its endpoint C has 1,332 facets, 45 vertices, and face vector

$$f(C) = (45, 795, 2750, 3330, 1332).$$

The ordered facets at this endpoint agree with the generalized triangulation used in the next stage. All 3,330 facet pairs, equivalently 6,660 half-facets, were checked across that conversion. Up to this point the reduction is a closed-manifold PL equivalence in the simplicial category. It does not transport the covering involution or the branch and twin markings.

3.2. Puncturing and the manifold with boundary

The reduction certificate verifies that simplex 25 of C, with vertex labels [3,19,419,504,918], is embedded. Remove its open interior and write $M = C \setminus \operatorname{int}(\sigma)$. This leaves 1,331 pentachora, with $\partial M = \partial\sigma$. A native Regina trace of 5,173 macro blocks, containing 54,563 explicit guarded 2–4 kicks and recorded simplification calls, implies the existence of a PL homeomorphism $h : M \longrightarrow T_5$. The first simplification produces 51 pentachora. The final endpoint is the five-pentachoron manifold T_5 named in Table 1.

This earlier native trace was replayed with its recorded block hashes in the specified Linux Regina environment. Its simplification calls remain a software dependency of Proposition 3.1; they are not expanded into individual moves by the new terminal certificate. The explicit boundary of T_5 is identified with the standard one-tetrahedron PL three-sphere of signature `bkaagj`. Nothing in the argument at this stage assumes that T_5 is a four-ball.

3.3. The cap replacement

Let B be the cone on the recognized PL sphere ∂T_5. It is a PL four-ball. The certificate supplies an explicit boundary PL isomorphism $f : \partial B \longrightarrow \partial T_5$ and forms the union $T_5 \cup_f B$. It checks that both pieces embed in the union and intersect exactly in their identified boundary. Their ordered affine subface identifications are preserved and reflected by the attaching maps.

As a numerical consistency check, the face counts satisfy

$$(1, 2, 10, 13, 5) + (2, 3, 4, 3, 1) - (1, 2, 2, 1, 0) = (2, 3, 12, 15, 6).$$

The full embedding and gluing checks, rather than this identity alone, justify the cap attachment. The capped triangulation is directly isomorphic to G_6: all thirty paired half-facet equations are checked, and no simplification is performed after capping.

To see that this recapping preserves the closed PL type, restrict h to the boundary of the deleted simplex. The map

$$f^{-1} \circ h|_{\partial\sigma} : \partial\sigma \longrightarrow \partial B$$

is a PL homeomorphism between the boundaries of two PL four-balls. By the PL Alexander trick, after suitable subdivisions it extends over the balls by coning. Gluing this extension to h gives

$$C = M \cup \sigma \;\cong_{\mathrm{PL}}\; T_5 \cup_f B \;\cong_{\mathrm{PL}}\; G_6.$$

Together with the closed simplicial moves this proves Proposition 3.1. The argument uses neither a four-dimensional Schoenflies assertion nor a pointwise fixed boundary triangulation throughout the punctured reduction. It only uses the PL homeomorphism of manifolds with boundary, the two cap balls, and the verified attaching map.

4. Local moves and certificate soundness

4.1. The permitted moves

The terminal certificate uses Pachner moves and admissible 2–0 moves about edges or triangles. A Pachner move replaces one side of the boundary of a five-simplex by the complementary side. The four-dimensional move types are 1–5, 2–4, 3–3, 4–2 and 5–1. Under the usual admissibility conditions these preserve PL type [12].

An edge or triangle 2–0 move removes two pentachora meeting around a degree-two face and identifies the outer facets in pairs. The selected face must be valid and interior, the two pentachora must be distinct, and its link must be the appropriate doubled-simplex sphere. Further identification conditions exclude closed chains of faces that would invalidate the replacement. For the closed inputs here, these are tested as acyclicity conditions on the affected face-pair identifications.

Admissible edge and triangle 2–0 moves are PL-preserving local simplifications [13, Section 4.1 and Appendix C]. Their guarded implementation and restrictions on face identifications are documented in Regina [14]. The flattening quotient itself is not the homeomorphism: the local replacement preserves the ambient PL manifold. The certificate uses these admissible operations directly.

4.2. Encoding and a soundness lemma

A record in the terminal certificate is a quadruple (a, m, i, b). The strings a and b are canonical classic Regina isomorphism signatures. Decode a to obtain a canonically labelled triangulation; m specifies the move type and the dimension of the selected face, and i is its index in that decoding. Perform the guarded move and require that the resulting classic signature equals b exactly. Consecutive records must have identical adjoining signatures.

The code P_k denotes a Pachner move about a face of dimension k: it replaces $5 - k$ pentachora by $k + 1$, changing their number by $2k - 4$. Thus P_0, P_1, P_2, P_3, P_4 denote 5–1, 4–2, 3–3, 2–4, and 1–5 moves, respectively. The codes `Z1` and `Z2` denote the edge and triangle 2–0 operations, each changing that number by minus two. The checker validates the face index, move legality, count change, and output signature separately. The supplied certificate is pinned to the exact hash in Appendix A.

Lemma 4.1 (certificate soundness). Suppose a finite sequence of records chains from signature a_0 to signature a_N. Suppose each recorded local move is admissible and preserves PL type, and its output has the recorded next signature. Then the triangulations decoded from a_0 and a_N are PL-homeomorphic.

Proof. Each local move gives a PL equivalence from its source to its output. Equality of the output and next-source signatures supplies a combinatorial isomorphism to the canonical representative used by the next record. Composing these equivalences proves the claim. In particular, several forward paths with a common endpoint may be combined by symmetry and transitivity of PL homeomorphism; reverse-move logs are unnecessary for this inference.

5. The terminal standardness certificate

Let S_2 be the double of a four-simplex: take two abstract four-simplices and identify each pair of corresponding boundary facets by the identity. This is the standard PL four-sphere. The verifier constructs it explicitly and checks that its signature is `cPkbbbbaaaaaaaa`. It also agrees with Regina's `Example4.sphere()`. Let S_6 and W be the triangulations in Table 1. The three recorded paths are

$$G_6 \longrightarrow W \longleftarrow S_6 \longleftarrow S_2.$$

Table 2. Complete terminal paths and their recorded size bounds.

Path	Moves	Max. pentachora	Vertices
$G_6 \to W$	6,814	22	2
$S_6 \to W$	1,519	16	2
$S_2 \to S_6$	103	14	2–5

Table 3. Individually checked moves in each terminal path.

Path	5–1	4–2	3–3	2–4	2–0 edge	2–0 triangle
$G_6 \to W$	0	0	5,830	492	417	75
$S_6 \to W$	0	0	1,315	102	81	21
$S_2 \to S_6$	3	6	80	14	0	0
Total	3	6	7,225	608	498	96

Every record in these paths passes the checks of Section 4. The first two paths contain only 3–3, 2–4, and admissible 2–0 moves. The third is entirely Pachner. The total is 8,436 moves, comprising 7,842 Pachner moves and 594 2–0 moves. There are no edge collapses in this final certificate.

Proof of Theorem 1.2. By Lemma 4.1 the three paths establish $G_6 \cong_{\mathrm{PL}} W$, $S_6 \cong_{\mathrm{PL}} W$, and $S_2 \cong_{\mathrm{PL}} S_6$. Since S_2 is the explicit double of a four-simplex, it is a standard PL sphere. Symmetry and transitivity give $G_6 \cong_{\mathrm{PL}} S^4$.

5.1. Independent checks of the terminal certificate

An independently written full-path checker imports none of the discovery or supplied verification code. It checks the endpoint signatures against separately specified constants, rejects malformed records, tests the canonical source states, and checks the selected faces, guarded local operations, exact count changes, and every next signature. All 8,435 distinct states are checked to be valid, closed, connected, orientable, and of Euler characteristic two. The checker was executed with Python optimization enabled; its essential checks use explicit failures rather than assertions.

A second checker treats all 594 2–0 steps independently of Regina's 2–0 move implementation. It checks the doubled-link gluing permutations and the acyclicity of the relevant face identifications. It then rebuilds the surviving facet pairing by tracing through the removed pillow and composing the explicit affine permutations. Every reconstructed target has the required signature. This checker

never invokes `move20`, `has20`, or `twoZeroMove`. It still shares Regina's signature codec, skeleton and validity routines, and simplex construction.

Finally, a dependency check reconstructs the capped endpoint recorded by the earlier reduction from its actual facet-pairing data, checks all thirty reciprocal gluing equations, and confirms that it is exactly the starting G_6 of the terminal certificate. Thus the new proof attaches to the previously verified reduction without a relabelling or endpoint ambiguity. This check also binds the relevant completed receipts and source files by their recorded hashes.

The full independent replay took 28.4 seconds and the separate 2–0 reconstruction took 2.2 seconds in the recorded Python 3.12.14 / Regina 7.4.1 environment. The hardened v1.1 supplied verifier was also executed successfully with Python optimization enabled, in 26.3 seconds. These are observed execution times, not hardware-independent bounds.

6. The smooth conclusion and the scope of the result

Proof of Theorem 1.1. By Construction input 2.1, X_0 is a compatible smoothing of the PL manifold underlying K_0. Proposition 3.1 identifies that manifold with G_6, and Theorem 1.2 identifies G_6 with the standard PL sphere. Therefore $X_0 \cong_{\mathrm{PL}} S^4$. A compact PL four-manifold admits a compatible smoothing unique up to diffeomorphism [7, Theorem 3.5(2)]. This is uniqueness for a fixed PL structure; see also the classical smoothing theory of Hirsch-Mazur [9, Part II, Theorem 4.2], with Cerf's theorem $\Gamma_4 = 0$ [10] among its low-dimensional ingredients. Applying this to the compatible smooth structure in the construction yields $X_0 \cong_{\mathrm{DIFF}} S^4$.

The conclusion is nonequivariant. It identifies the underlying smooth manifold, as asked in [1, Question 1.4]. The reduction does not establish that the branch two-knot is unknotted, that the covering involution is conjugate to a standard involution, or that the marked twin configuration is standardized.

6.1. Connected sums and covering involutions

Let $F = \tau^0\rho^1\, P(-2,3,7)$. For a positive integer r, let F_r be the connected sum of r copies of F, let $Y_r = \Sigma_2(S^4, F_r)$, and let ι_r be its covering involution.

Corollary 6.1. For every $r \geq 1$, the manifold Y_r is diffeomorphic to the standard S^4. The covering involutions, transported to the oriented standard S^4, form an infinite family of pairwise inequivalent involutions under orientation-preserving equivariant diffeomorphism. None preserves a Riemannian metric of positive scalar curvature.

Proof. The connected-sum construction of branched covers lifts a summing ball meeting the branch surface in a standard disk to a standard four-ball. Consequently, Theorem 1.1 gives

$$Y_r = \Sigma_2(S^4, F_r) \cong_{\mathrm{DIFF}} \#_{j=1}^{r} X_0 \cong_{\mathrm{DIFF}} S^4.$$

Miyazawa's Real Bauer-Furuta degree calculation gives $|\deg(F)| = 3$, and his connected-sum formula gives $|\deg(F_r)| = 3^r$ [2, Theorem 4.32 and Proposition 3.6]. These values are invariant under equivariant diffeomorphism. They distinguish the covering actions and, by the positive-scalar-curvature obstruction in [2, proof of Theorem 4.46], exclude an invariant metric of positive scalar curvature for every $r \geq 1$.

Here equivalence is taken in the oriented category: an equivalence is an orientation-preserving diffeomorphism intertwining the involutions. This supplies standard total spaces for the family in Miyazawa's Theorem 1.7. Topological conjugacy of these involutions, or topological unknotting of the branch two-knots, is not asserted. The exotic projective-plane embeddings and the associated topologically equivalent involutions on the standard $\overline{\mathbb{CP}}^2$ discussed in [2, Theorem 4.38] and [1, Corollary 1.5] are a distinct conclusion.

7. ~~Certificate extraction~~Handle diagrams and the homotopy sphere Z

7.1. The diagrams

Figures 1 and 2 reproduce the third author's diagrams in dotted-circle notation [17, Section 5.4]. Each has three dotted circles (1-handles) and five 2-handles with framings $0, 0, 0, 0, -1$. As drawn, the diagrams have 64 and 60 crossings. Let W_Z be the 4-manifold built from the 0-, 1- and 2-handles of Figure 2.

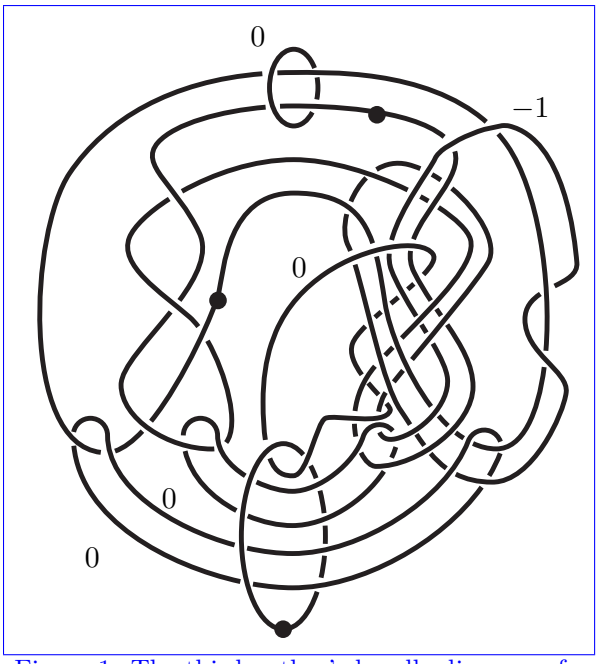


Figure 1. The third author's handle diagram of X_0.

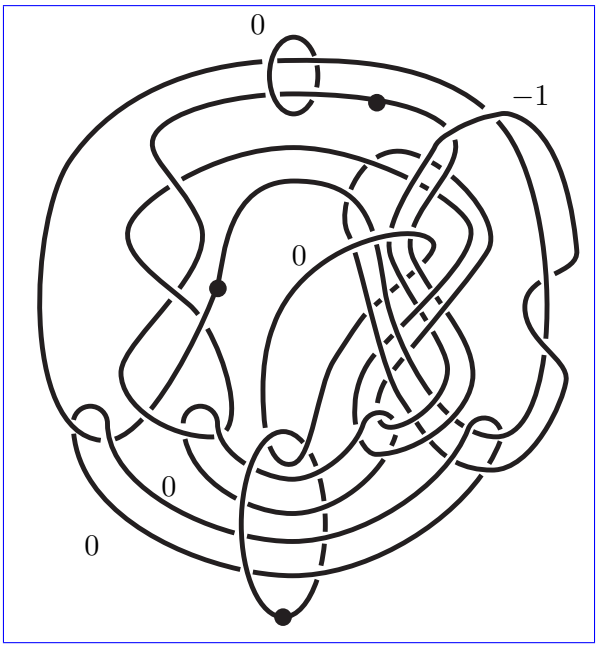


Figure 2. The third author's modified diagram, presenting Z.

The third author computed that the 2-handlebody of his diagram has trivial fundamental group. We confirmed this independently, with explicit Tietze-reduction certificates, for our transcriptions of the first drawings of both figures (Section 7.2); by Lemma 7.1 it also holds for W_Z. Section 7.4 identifies ∂W°, and hence ∂W_Z, with $\#_2(S^1 \times S^2)$ by an explicit Pachner path. So the diagram closes up with two 3-handles and one 4-handle. By Laudenbach-Poénaru [15], every diffeomorphism of $\#_2(S^1 \times S^2)$ extends over $\natural_2(S^1 \times B^3)$. Hence

$$Z \;=\; W_Z \cup_\partial \natural_2(S^1 \times B^3)$$

is well defined up to diffeomorphism, independently of the gluing map. Its handle counts are $(1,3,5,2,1)$, so $\chi(Z)=2$. Together with $\pi_1(Z)=1$, this shows that Z is a homotopy four-sphere. By Freedman [5] it is homeomorphic to S^4, so the question is again its smooth structure.

The figures are vector drawings, and we read each link from the PDF stroke paths. Our transcription of Figure 2 presents the same framed link as both of the third author's freehand redrawings of Section 7.2, and our transcription of Figure 1 the same framed link as its redrawing; both are certified as in Proposition 7.3. In each figure one tightly drawn hook, where the -1-framed 2-handle passes the lower inner 0-framed 2-handle, was read in the natural way, as a clasp. The redrawings, which have no such hook, confirm this reading.

7.2. The first drawings and a handle slide

The third author's first drawings of Figures 1 and 2 differ from the present figures at one spot. Just to the left of the label -1, the -1-framed 2-handle passes under two dotted circles in succession, where Figures 1 and 2 show it passing over them (Figure 3). We write Z° for the closed manifold presented by the first drawing of Figure 2, and W° for its 2-handlebody.

The discrepancy came to light when the third author redrew Figure 2 freehand on a tablet, twice, with every dotted circle in the standard position of Section 7.3. Using the invariants of Proposition 7.3, the two redrawings present the same framed link, and it is not the link of the first drawing. Among all 60 single crossing changes of the first drawing and all 1,770 pairs, exactly one pair gives a link with the hyperbolic volume of the redrawn link: the two crossings at this spot. For this pair the equality of links is certified as in Proposition 7.3. The redrawing of Figure 1 differs from the first drawing of Figure 1 in the same two crossings; there the search covered 2,080 cases. The third author then corrected Figures 1 and 2 at this spot.

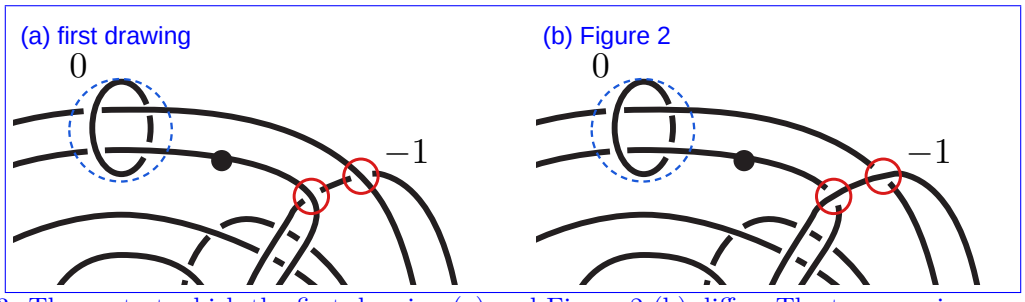


Figure 3. The spot at which the first drawing (a) and Figure 2 (b) differ. The two crossings are circled. The dashed circle marks the 0-framed 2-handle μ of Lemma 7.1. Figure 1 and its first drawing differ in the same way.

With the dotted-circle basis fixed, the two versions are not related by an isotopy in the boundary of the 1-handlebody: the attaching circle of the -1-framed 2-handle represents different classes in $H_1(\#_3(S^1\times S^2);\mathbb{Z})$. It links one of the two dotted circles once in the first drawing, and the other one in Figure 2.

More is true. Filling each dotted cusp of the link exterior along its zero slope gives the exterior of the five framed attaching circles in $\#_3(S^1\times S^2)$. For Figure 2 and its first drawing, these five-cusped exteriors each have 572 connected 3-fold covers, and the multisets of their first homology groups differ. For Figure 1 and its first drawing, the 31 connected double covers already differ. The covers are enumerated combinatorially and their homology is computed exactly, so no homeomorphism of $\#_3(S^1\times S^2)$ carries one family of attaching circles to the other. In particular, the two versions

are not related by an isotopy in the boundary of the 1-handlebody, with any choice of basis, or by 1-handle slides. None of this obstructs a slide of one 2-handle over another. As the third author observed, a single such slide relates the two diagrams.

Lemma 7.1. Sliding the -1-framed 2-handle once over the 0-framed 2-handle μ of Figure 3, followed by an isotopy, carries the first drawing of Figure 2 to Figure 2. Hence W° is diffeomorphic to W_Z, and Z° to Z. The same holds for Figure 1 and its first drawing.

Proof. In each drawing, μ is a small unknot that passes over two parallel strands on one side and under them on the other, so it is a meridian of this pair. The two strands belong to the two dotted circles at the spot. The two strands, the intervening arc of μ, and the arc of the -1-framed component between the circled crossings bound an empty quadrilateral region of the diagram. We checked this directly in the planar rotation systems of all four supplied transcriptions; the exact check is included with the manuscript sources. Its empty interior supplies the narrow strip from μ to the spot, with no intervening strands. Choose an untwisted band in this strip and slide the -1-framed 2-handle over the zero-framed parallel of μ along it, and then isotope the parallel copy of μ along the strip until it lies beside the spot. An arc that passes under a pair of strands, band-summed with an adjacent meridian of the pair, is isotopic to an arc that passes over the pair, for the appropriate side of the band. So the slide changes the two circled crossings and nothing else. The framing remains -1, because μ has framing 0 and links the -1-framed 2-handle zero times. As a check on the diagrams, in the orientations of the supplied transcriptions the slide subtracts the class of μ from that of the -1-framed component, which is exactly the change observed, and leaves its linking numbers with the other 2-handles unchanged, since μ links none of them.

Thus Figure 2 presents a manifold diffeomorphic to Z°. Sections 7.3-7.5 prove that Z° is standard, and Section 7.6 treats Z directly.

7.3. A diagram of Z° in standard position

Burke's converter Katie [13] requires each dotted circle to be drawn without self-crossings and without crossings with other dotted circles, and to be oriented counterclockwise. Its crossings must also form exactly one over-block and one under-block: one arc of the circle passes over every strand it meets, and the complementary arc passes under every strand it meets. We call this standard position. Neither the first drawing nor Figure 2 is in standard position. The redrawings are, and they present Z (Section 7.2). We therefore built a standard-position diagram of Z° from the second redrawing. That redrawing has 151 crossings after transcription, and we added two clasps.

Lemma 7.2. Let D be a diagram in standard position, c a dotted circle of D, and t a point of c between its over-block and its under-block. Let $D^\sharp$ be obtained by pushing a thin band from a framed component K along a planar arc γ ending at t. The two strands of the band cross each strand met by γ at the same height. Dotted circles met by γ are crossed over their under-blocks and under their over-blocks. The tip of the band hooks c at t: it passes under c on the over-block side of t and over c on the under-block side. Then $D^\sharp$ is in standard position, and $D^\sharp$ differs from D by a crossing change between K and c along the arc γ.

Proof. On c, the hook adds one over-crossing at the end of the over-block and one under-crossing at the start of the under-block. On every other dotted circle, the band adds pairs of crossings inside a single block. No dotted circle meets another, so the block structure is preserved. A band whose tip hooks a strand is the standard picture of a crossing change along its core arc.

We searched over arcs γ and heights for one clasp of the -1-framed 2-handle around each of the two dotted circles of Figure 3. The result is a 188-crossing diagram D° in standard position (Figure 4).

Proposition 7.3. The diagram D° and the first drawing of Figure 2 present the same framed link. The correspondence takes dotted circles to dotted circles and preserves every framing.

Proof. SnapPy [18] finds a positive isometry of the two link exteriors with a component correspondence π preserving the dotted or framed roles. In the meridian–Seifert-longitude bases its cusp maps satisfy

$$(\mu_i, \lambda_i) \longmapsto (\epsilon_i \mu'_{\pi(i)}, \epsilon_i \lambda'_{\pi(i)}), \qquad \epsilon_i \in \{+1, -1\},$$

with the same sign on both curves of each cusp, and with the framing labels agreeing under π. Thus every peripheral matrix is $+I$ or $-I$. The map extends over meridional fillings to an equivalence of the links in S^3 and preserves each framing slope $f_i\mu_i + \lambda_i$ up to overall sign. It therefore identifies the framed links, including their dotted components.

The decorated canonical isometry signatures are also identical, and the multisets of H_1 over all 255 connected double covers agree. These are additional consistency checks. Numerical geometry is used to find the isometry, while the proof uses the positive marked identification. SnapPy documents positive isometry results as rigorous [18]; a failed numerical search alone would not certify non-equivalence. The software and peripheral-map dependencies remain explicit in Appendix B.

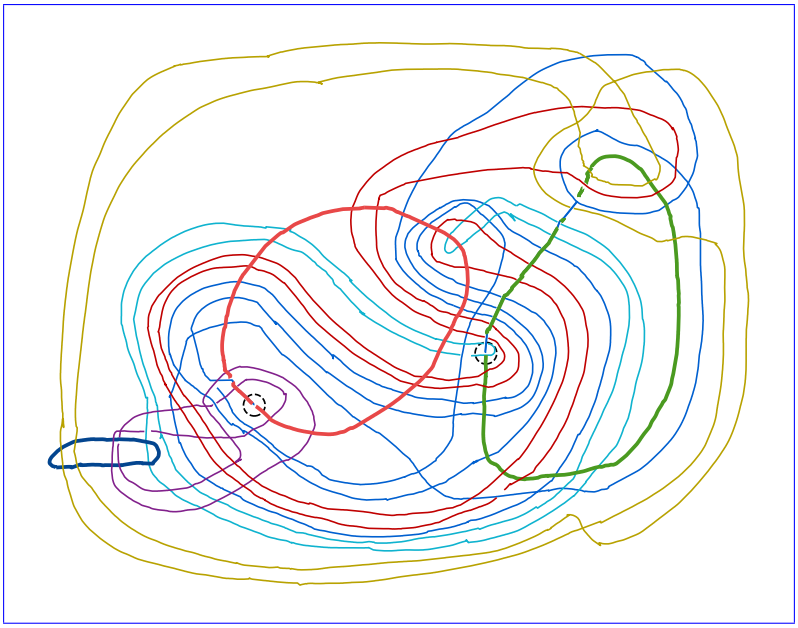


Figure 4. The standard-position diagram D°: the third author's second redrawing, with the two computed clasps (dashed circles) of the -1-framed 2-handle (blue), which change back the two crossings of Figure 3. Dotted circles are drawn thick.

7.4. Triangulating W° and closing up

Katie, compiled from the Regina 7.4.1 release source, converts D° into an ideal triangulation of W°. The framing integers supplied to Katie are measured relative to the Seifert longitudes of the

corresponding components. The output has 1,528 pentachora and 13 vertices. Twelve vertex links are PL 3-spheres. The thirteenth is an ideal vertex, whose link is a closed 3-manifold with homology $\mathbb{Z}^2$. The triangulation has $H_1 = 0$.

Every pentachoron has exactly one corner at the ideal vertex. Removing a small open neighbourhood of that vertex leaves a prism in each pentachoron, and we triangulate each prism by four pentachora. This gives a finite triangulation of W° with 6,112 pentachora. Its boundary is exactly the 1,528-tetrahedron vertex link, and the checks confirm the boundary identification and the vertex links. Regina's simplification then reduces it to 1,392 pentachora with a boundary of 826 tetrahedra. The recorded invocation was rerun in the specified environment and reproduced the identical labelled endpoint.

Next we change the boundary by 22,304 three-dimensional Pachner moves: 10,744 of type 2–3, 11,543 of type 3–2, five of type 1–4 and twelve of type 4–1. Each move is realized by attaching one pentachoron along the support of the move. Each support is a 3-ball in the boundary, and the attachment meets the boundary exactly in it. An independent audit confirms these local hypotheses for all 22,304 attachments. Each attachment is therefore a PL collar extension and preserves the PL type. The result has 23,696 pentachora, and its boundary is the six-tetrahedron triangulation `gLALQccbefefdpcghfc` of $\#_2(S^1 \times S^2)$. This identifies ∂W°, as claimed in Section 7.1.

For the 3- and 4-handles we use an explicit triangulation H of $\natural_2(S^1 \times B^3)$ with that same boundary. It starts as the boundary connected sum of two explicit triangulated products $\Delta^3 \times S^1$. Fifteen guarded edge collapses reduce it to a nine-pentachoron reference, and 465 guarded attachments then bring its boundary to `gLALQccbefefdpcghfc`, giving 474 pentachora. We glue H to the lower piece by an explicit isomorphism of boundary triangulations. By the argument of Section 7.1, applied to W°, the resulting closed triangulation K° is a triangulation of Z°. It has 24,170 pentachora and face vector

$$f(K^\circ) = (19,\ 12136,\ 48374,\ 60425,\ 24170), \qquad \chi = 2.$$

An independent check of the raw facet pairings confirms that K° is closed and orientable. It also certifies that each of its 19 vertex links is a PL 3-sphere. For each link it constructs a presentation of π_1 from the triangles and eliminates every generator by recorded substitutions, which a second program replays. The link is then a PL 3-sphere by the Poincaré conjecture [16] together with uniqueness of PL structures in dimension three [8]. The vertex links of the X_0 master were certified differently, by bistellar reductions (Section 2.3).

7.5. Reduction of K° to the standard sphere

Three recorded paths connect K° to S_2:

$$K^\circ \longrightarrow Z_8^\circ \longrightarrow W_4 \longleftarrow S_2.$$

Here Z_8° and W_4 are the triangulations of Table 1. The first path is recorded as a sequence of guarded moves on the labelled triangulation. A separate verifier replays it from the exact glued triangulation, identified by its file hash, and checks the final labelled encoding against the recorded one. The last two paths use the record format of Section 4.2.

Table 4. Paths for Z° and their individually checked moves.

Path	Moves	Max.	Pachner	2–0 (v/e/t)	4–4	Collapse
$K^\circ \to Z_8^\circ$	780,847	24,170	399,289	6,891 / 71,713 / 15,485	286,182	1,287
$Z_8^\circ \to W_4$	423	14	399	0 / 13 / 7	3	1
$S_2 \to W_4$	7	10	5	0 / 0 / 0	0	2
Total	781,277		399,693	6,891 / 71,726 / 15,492	286,185	1,290

The Pachner moves in the first path comprise 15,036 of type 4–2, 293,738 of type 3–3, 82,355 of type 2–4 and 8,160 of type 1–5. In the second path there are 7 of type 4–2, 369 of type 3–3, 20 of type 2–4 and 3 of type 1–5. In the third there is one 3–3 move and four 2–4 moves.

Unlike the terminal certificate of Section 5, these paths also use 4–4 moves, 2–0 moves about vertices, and edge collapses. In every case we use Regina's guarded operations [14], which preserve the PL type of a closed triangulation; see also [13, Section 4.1 and Appendix C]. Lemma 4.1 applies verbatim to the last two paths. The first path is recorded on a labelled triangulation instead of by signatures, and the same composition argument applies to it.

Proof of Theorem 1.4. By Sections 7.1-7.4, K° triangulates Z°. The three paths give $K^\circ \cong_{\mathrm{PL}} Z_8^\circ \cong_{\mathrm{PL}} W_4 \cong_{\mathrm{PL}} S_2$, so Z° is PL-homeomorphic to S^4. As in Section 6, uniqueness of compatible smoothings of a PL four-manifold [7, 9, 10] shows that Z° is diffeomorphic to S^4. By Lemma 7.1, Z is diffeomorphic to Z°, and hence to S^4. A diffeomorphism is in particular a PL homeomorphism of the compatible PL structures [9], so Z is also PL-homeomorphic to S^4.

7.6. A direct computation for Z

The redrawings are in standard position and present Z, so Katie can also be applied to Z directly, without Lemma 7.1. This computation, from the first redrawing, was in fact carried out first.

Proposition 7.4. The handle diagram of Figure 2 yields a closed triangulation of Z with 25,200 pentachora, which reduces by recorded guarded moves to the six-pentachoron triangulation Z_6 of Table 1.

- *Construction.* Katie converts a 181-crossing transcription of the first redrawing into an ideal triangulation of W_Z with 1,488 pentachora. That transcription agrees with ours as a framed link. The staircase truncation gives 5,952 pentachora. After reduction, a boundary path of 22,581 layers is attached, followed by a 483-pentachoron cap with seven boundary tetrahedra. The result is a closed triangulation with 25,200 pentachora. A fresh replay of the whole construction passes, including the vertex links of the closed triangulation.
- *Reduction.* A logged path of 472,570 guarded moves reduces the closed triangulation from 25,200 pentachora to 16. It is stored in four segments, of 1,100, 566, 6,909 and 463,995 moves, passing through 22,988, 21,856 and 8,038 pentachora. All four segments have been replayed independently. Each replay ends at the recorded labelled triangulation, and each join between consecutive segments is checked on the exact labelled triangulation.
- *Terminal steps.* Twelve further moves (eight 3–3 moves and four edge 2–0 moves) reach Z_8, and 416 recorded moves reach Z_6. Both short paths have been replayed.

Proposition 7.4 records a separate reduction to the exact endpoint Z_6. A standardness identification of Z_6 has been reported, but its supporting reference or certificate is not specified in the present

proof record. Supplying that evidence would complete a second proof of Theorem 1.4 without Lemma 7.1. The proof in Section 7.5 is already complete through the explicit standard reference S_2 and does not use that additional identification.

Remark 7.5. Figure 1 is the third author's handle diagram of X_0. It is not used in the proof of Theorem 1.1, which rests on the branched-cover construction of Section 2. Documenting the geometric derivation of Figure 1 from that construction, and standardizing a triangulation obtained from Figure 1, would give a second proof of Theorem 1.1. Its redrawing is already in standard position and presents the same framed link as Figure 1, so Katie can be applied to it directly, as in Section 7.6.

8. Certificate extraction

The search combined growth by 2–4 moves, mixing by 3–3 moves and reduction by admissible edge and triangle 2–0 moves, following the simplification strategy described by Burke [13, Section 4.1]. Searches from G_6 and a standard reference reached a common isomorphism signature. Loop erasure and extraction from the visited-state graph produced the finite paths in Tables 2–3. Discovery was randomized; verification of the recorded certificate is deterministic.

The paths for Z° were found in a similar way. The long path came from a randomized guarded search, which alternated bursts of 2–4 growth with 3–3 and 4–4 mixing, reduction by 2–0 moves and edge collapses, and occasional vertex births by 1–5 moves. From Z°_8, a search of excursions and descents reached four pentachora. A bounded bidirectional breadth-first search then joined that point to S_2, and those steps are recorded from the sphere's side. The standard-position diagram D° was found by a search over clasp placements. Each candidate was screened by hyperbolic volume against the link of the first drawing of Figure 2, and the winning candidate was then certified as in Proposition 7.3.

Acknowledgements and AI assistance

The authors acknowledge substantial assistance from AI tools developed by OpenAI and Anthropic. These tools were used in computational exploration, software development and review, checking mathematical arguments, and preparing the manuscript. The authors take responsibility for the mathematical claims, the interpretation and verification of the computational results, and the final manuscript.

Appendix A. Reproduction and exact input identity

The terminal certificate is ~~`x0_standard_certificate.json`~~`x0_standard_certificate.json`, distributed in ~~`x0_is_standard_v1.1.zip`~~`x0_is_standard_v1.1.zip`. It is byte-for-byte identical to the certificate audited in ~~`x0_standardness_audit_v1.zip`~~`x0_standardness_audit_v1.zip`. The v1.1 revision changes the documentation and supplied verifier; it does not change the mathematical move data. The certificate SHA-256 is

```
e9ba9f14831bb0da32043d7d93eb0148f0683e2a6e4f67d5156e8e9fc94adcdf
```

For the supplied replay, use Regina 7.4.1 and, from the extracted `x0_is_standard` directory, run

```
python -O verify_x0_standard.py x0_standard_certificate.json
```

Exit status zero indicates success. The executable source performs explicit checks; optimization cannot disable them. In the independent audit directory, run the following commands with fresh output filenames:

```
python -O audit/independent_replay.py --output replay_fresh.json

python -O audit/independent_two_zero.py \
  source/x0_is_standard/x0_standard_certificate.json \
  --output two_zero_fresh.json

python -O audit/verify_bindings.py --output bindings_fresh.json
```

These commands respectively replay every terminal move, independently reconstruct every 2–0 step, and check the byte identities and the exact interface with the earlier accepted reduction. They do not rerun the large construction or punctured macro trace. That earlier trace is reproduced from the separate X_0-to-G_6 package in its recorded compatible environment.

Table ~~4.~~ 5. Certificate supplements and their mathematical roles.

Key	Supplement	Role
C1	Marked X_0 construction dossier	Source pair, roll, cap and branched-cover identification
C2	`x0_to_G6_verified_v1.zip`	Links, contractions, flips, punctured macros and capping
C3	`x0_is_standard_v1.1.zip`	Three terminal paths and supplied verifier
C4	`x0_standardness_audit_v1.zip`	Independent terminal checks and dependency binding
C5	`coordinate_audit/` in the repository	Peripheral basis, covering projection and transverse-arc audit
C6	`maggie_twist_verified_v1.zip`	Swapped-coordinate master, move replay and vertex-link recognition

The ~~new source bundle includes C3 and C4. C1 and C2 are separately distributed dependencies~~manuscript-source bundle contains the paper, figures and local corrected-diagram checks. The proof supplements C1–C6 are separate distributions; they are not bundled with this manuscript ZIP. C1 is identified in particular by ~~`GEOMETRIC_CONSTRUCTION_ADMISSION.json`~~`GEOMETRIC_CONSTRUCTION_ADMISSION.json` and by the original marked master. C4 retains selected prior receipts; it is not a replacement for the full construction dossier or the complete earlier reduction package. C5 supplies the additional marked-coordinate checks restored in this revision.

Marked master

`251d7ad38235869fa268e9ee6ec9da2f397cf1ca71db267d0bf0ca9b434c5e4c`

Geometric admission receipt

`28c0dddcf683d98d943b3a6936d072c9a394ff351f8aad44b62850f00925c969`

C2: X_0-to-G_6 archive

`44c6c1e7c8498c929b956f3cd26df9eabf13667e2a6d4962a7d44bc497bc3f57`

C3: terminal v1.1 archive

```
a350c70b9407c9017a5691c8e0df3ce39fe2b5232246522c8a0c3548d7994dfa
```

C4: independent audit archive

```
16033754602a61c73eda10934a5f7812c95a2462658fc79ad8dd4ba270da87b6
```

C6: swapped-coordinate control. The archive `maggie_twist_verified_v1.zip` contains the closed master, the 161,328-move certificate and the strict verification launcher. From its extracted directory, with a fresh default output directory, run

```
python3 -m pip install regina==7.4.1
sh verify_certificate_strict.sh
```

This launcher checks subprocess exit statuses directly and preserves assertions in every Python child; it must not be replaced by a call with optimization enabled. The successful receipt is `STRICT_VERIFICATION.json`. The archive and its two principal inputs have SHA-256 hashes

```
C6 archive
8a0cdb66a11de260ac7de2739dbffe5f6ff159cd2e0a216884bcad5095840e25
input/marked_control.json.gz
473f5dcbf801a7ddf2a3b37197b6c2205c8674ba4ecaeb27ad7a70e0f41c76f6
results/red_s0.moves.jsonl.gz
0126abc89757878d8ecb9eb16299d3dd2c063c3cd491a8e0bf295c722f99a331
```

Local corrected-diagram audit. The manuscript sources include a standard-Python check of the four labelled PD records used in Lemma 7.1:

```
python3 corrected_figures_check/audit_corrected_pd.py \
  corrected_figures_check --output LOCAL_PD_AUDIT_fresh.json
```

It checks the two crossing switches, the empty quadrilateral in each planar rotation system, and the linking and framing conditions for the slide. This check starts from the supplied PD records; it does not re-extract the drawings or replace the geometric handle-slide argument.

Cover obstruction (Section 7.2). The same four records, with SnapPy, give the cover comparison of Section 7.2:

```
python3 corrected_figures_check/cover_obstruction.py \
  corrected_figures_check/old_fig2.json \
  corrected_figures_check/new_fig2.json \
  --degrees 2,3 --output cover_fig2.json
```

and likewise for Figure 1. The recorded results are in `corrected_figures_check/COVER_OBSTRUCTION_fig1.json` and `COVER_OBSTRUCTION_fig2.json`. This comparison supports the remark in Section 7.2 and is not used in the proof of Theorem 1.4.

Certificate for Z° (Sections 7.3-7.5). The diagram, triangulations, receipts and code are distributed in `published_fig2_S4.zip`, and the 780,847-move log in `published_fig2_closed_path_moves.tar.xz`. The key files are bound by the following SHA-256 hashes.

```
diagram/fig2_published_katie.json  5aeaea4ffa70b3d4084fbae11cd144c2
                                   56ae3af361cbebb10da07166cad3427f
```

```
katie/raw_katie.rga                f1590ec6de3e7a9d9fdeb2175f98a9cd
                                   70688027776d274de0f2da4718a119bb
closed/closed_candidate.rga        e6281897c358e315757a77f851433db1
                                   527f48d71b97ec0056174e0a7eb2c467
final/CERTIFICATE.json             54819a4b09ece5267e08d00e6168b674
                                   642c5d2c4b379259db8ff1b62a6d8a91
closed-path move log (tar.xz)      cf0a077bc3680e331a444b8b4fe1564e
                                   5077d00d20ca51d81c610717cb70e4ab
```

The terminal paths replay in seconds:

```
python simplify_penta.py verify final/CERTIFICATE.json \
  --expect-start iLAALMQkabcccfefhghhhcaaavava2aaaoacbZb6aEa8a8a
```

The long path replays from the glued triangulation with `verify_closed_bursts.py`. With the recognition helper of Appendix B, which reduces the cost of vertex-link recognition, this took 23 minutes.

Appendix B. Verification dependencies

The proof combines mathematical local-move facts with exact finite computations. The initial construction identification retains its recorded source and peripheral transport semantics, geometric collar and cap arguments, and branch-model checks. The original closed master has separate vertex-link certificates. The closed simplicial contractions and flips have explicit traces. The punctured stage retains Regina's simplification implementation as recorded in C2. The capping step uses explicit boundary and affine gluing checks.

For the new terminal segment, the full checker still uses Regina for guarded Pachner moves, isomorphism signatures, skeletons and validity queries. The second checker independently implements the 2–0 admissibility and facet reconstruction on the actual closed inputs, while sharing the signature codec, skeleton and simplex constructor. It is therefore a second move implementation, not a wholly independent topology software stack. No assertion of formal proof-assistant verification is made.

The recorded positive paths and their checked endpoints establish the terminal equivalences. The required computations are the full-path replay, the independent reconstruction of all 594 admissible 2–0 moves, and the binding of the terminal starting point to the capped reduction endpoint. The proof uses the admissible 2–0 operations directly and does not require their expansion into individual Pachner moves.

For the swapped-coordinate control, all four-dimensional moves are replayed directly in standard Python, while its manifold premise uses Regina 7.4.1 for recognition of the 4,226 vertex links. The strict launcher in C6 keeps the replay checks enabled.

For external review, the complete construction dossier should accompany the terminal certificate so that the identification in Construction input 2.1 can be assessed independently of the short standardization. The terminal theorem, its files and its exact standard reference can be checked on their own.

The proof of Theorem 1.4 has the following dependencies.

- *The diagrams.* It depends on the transcriptions of the first drawing of Figure 2 and of Figure 2 from their vector drawings (Section 7.1); Lemma 7.1 uses both to check the strip between μ

and the spot. It also depends on SnapPy and Spherogram [18] for the positive marked exterior identification and the supplementary signature and cover-homology checks in Proposition 7.3. Numerical geometry guides the search; the inference uses the returned positive identification and its integer peripheral maps.

- *Conversion.* It depends on Katie and on the correctness of Burke's conversion [13].
- *The lower piece.* One step uses Regina's native simplification. The recorded invocation was rerun in the specified environment and reproduced the identical labelled endpoint.
- *Recognition.* Vertex links are recognised through an explicit trivial-π_1 certificate, which a second program replays, together with the Poincaré conjecture [16]. This goes through a small helper that replaces Regina's 3-sphere and 3-ball recognition by such certificates and otherwise falls back to Regina. The helper does not alter the four-dimensional move routines.

- *Moves.* All closed-triangulation moves are Regina's guarded operations.
- *Closing up.* It uses the Laudenbach-Poénaru theorem [15].

Proposition 7.4 has analogous construction and replay dependencies. Completing an independent standardness proof through that route additionally requires the separate standardness reference or certificate for Z_6 described in Section 7.6. This is not a dependency of the proof of Theorem 1.4 in Section 7.5.

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